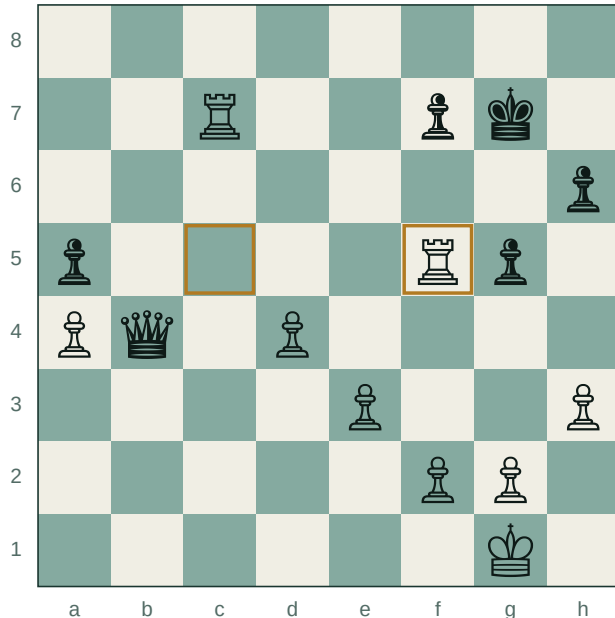


Queen-and-rook endings: Black, move 31

Queen-and-rook endings

Black to move



Previous move: 31.Rf5. Gold borders mark its start and finish.

WORKED CONTINUATION - COVER THIS SECTION FIRST

31...Qb1+ 32. Kh2 Qxf5

31...Qb1+ Check restricts White to 2 legal replies here. From b1 it attacks king on g1 and rook on f5. Recorded reply: **32.Kh2**.

32...Qxf5 The queen captures the rook on f5.

At the end, nominal material is White 11 / Black 13 (P=1, N/B=3, R=5, Q=9). Over this line, Black's balance changes by +5. Activity and king safety still affect the evaluation.

CHECKPOINT

Using P=1, N/B=3, R=5, Q=9, how much does Black's material balance change over the complete line? **Answer:** +5: the balance goes from -3 to +2. Count promotions and every recapture, not just the first gain.

CARRY THE IDEA INTO YOUR GAMES

Do not activate the king as casually as in a pure pawn ending. The remaining heavy pieces can still generate a mating net.

WHAT THIS POSITION TEACHES

When queens and rooks remain, mating threats coexist with endgame pawn races. Coordination and king shelter remain essential even on a sparse board.

HOW TO LOOK

Look for heavy-piece batteries, skewers, and checks that force a defender away from a promotion square or pawn.

The defending king is on g1. Geometrically undefended: rook on c7 and rook on f5. Check for tactical protection.